

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X
GEORGE JOHNSON, JR.,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE OFFICER
CHRISTOPHER MEYER, Shield No. 18501, NYPD
POLICE OFFICER BRANDON R. GENTZ, Shield No.
9505, and NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES
NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,

Defendants.
----- X

SUMMONS

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial.

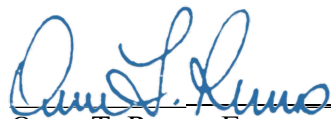
To the above-named defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
April 3, 2024

Yours, etc.

SHULMAN & HILL, PLLC



Omar T. Russo, Esq.

Attorneys for Plaintiff

1 State Street Plaza, 15th Floor
New York, New York 10004

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, New York, New
York 10007

NYPD POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER MEYER, Shield No. 18501, NYPD 75th Precinct; 1000 Sutter Avenue, Brooklyn, New York 11208

NYPD POLICE OFFICER BRANDON R. GENTZ, Shield No. 9505, NYPD 75th Precinct; 1000 Sutter Avenue, Brooklyn, New York 11208

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X

GEORGE JOHNSON, JR.,

Plaintiff,

INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE OFFICER
CHRISTOPHER MEYER, Shield No. 18501, NYPD
POLICE OFFICER BRANDON R. GENTZ, Shield No.
9505, and NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES
NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Defendants.

----- X

Plaintiff, GEORGE JOHNSON, JR., by his attorneys, Shulman-Hill, PLLC, as and for his
Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On April 25, 2023, at approximately 9:03 p.m., Plaintiff, while lawfully in the vicinity of Liberty Avenue and Pennsylvania Avenue, County of Kings, New York, was subject to an unlawful arrest, detention, and excessive use of force by the defendant officers. Plaintiff was subjected to assault, battery, denial of medical treatment, and approximately twenty-four (24) hours in unlawful custody between the NYPD 75th Precinct and Kings County Central Bookings. Plaintiff was deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802 and his constitutional, common law and statutory rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, detained, subjected to excessive force, passed along false accusations to prosecuting attorneys, and engaged in the malicious prosecution of Plaintiff, in violation of the Fourth, Fifth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff, George Johnson, Jr., is a resident of the state of New York.

3. NYPD Police Officer Christopher Meyer, Shield No. 18501, is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.

4. NYPD Police Officer Christopher Meyer, Shield No. 18501, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

5. Currently and at all times relevant herein, NYPD Police Officer Christopher Meyer, Shield No. 18501, was assigned to the NYPD 75th Precinct.

6. NYPD Police Officer Brandon R. Gentz, Shield No. 9505, is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.

7. NYPD Police Officer Brandon R. Gentz, Shield No. 9505, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

8. Currently and at all times herein, NYPD Police Officer Brandon R. Gentz, Shield No. 9505, was assigned to the NYPD 75th Precinct.

9. New York City Police Officers John Does #1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

10. Police Officers John Does #1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

11. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

12. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

13. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the City of New York in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

14. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, Plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on February 2, 2024.

15. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and the City of New York has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

16. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

17. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

18. On April 25, 2023, at approximately 9:03 p.m., Plaintiff was lawfully present at or near the intersection of Liberty Avenue and Pennsylvania Avenue, County of Kings, New York, when the defendant officers unlawfully descended upon and arrested Plaintiff without probable cause or legal justification.

19. At the aforementioned place and time, Plaintiff had just left his mother's house and was walking on Liberty Avenue toward the C train, headed home.

20. Plaintiff was wearing headphones, walking past a school bus depot and noticed an NYPD vehicle nearby.

21. Neither hearing nor seeing anything unusual, Plaintiff continued walking along Liberty Avenue.

22. Suddenly, Plaintiff observed an individual running up from behind him.

23. Unable to identify the stranger running at him, Plaintiff ran forward.

24. Eventually, Plaintiff came to a stop near some unmarked NYPD vehicles where he felt safe from the perceived assailant, speaking with the officers nearby.

25. It was at this point that the defendant officers began to arrest Plaintiff, restraining him with metal handcuffs and subjecting him to unlawful pat-down search.

26. During his arrest, the defendant officers slammed the plaintiff to the ground and pushed his face into the concrete, as well as bent his thumb backward, causing severe pain and physical injuries.

27. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officers have an objective basis to accuse Plaintiff of committing a crime or violating the law in any way.

28. At no point did the defendant officers recover any drugs, weapons, graffiti instruments, or other illegal contraband from Plaintiff or from a location that was in Plaintiff's possession, custody, or control.

29. Plaintiff did not resist arrest.

30. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and handcuffed by the defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause.

31. Thereafter, Plaintiff was transported against his will to the 75th Precinct, where he was fingerprinted, photographed, and placed in a holding cell.

32. While at the precinct, Plaintiff requested medical attention for his injuries, which included scrapes on his face, two black eyes, and a fractured right thumb.

33. The defendant officers denied his request, stating that it would only delay Plaintiff's processing.

34. The following day, Plaintiff was transported to Kings County Central Bookings, where he was again processed and placed in a holding cell.

35. While Plaintiff was in custody, the defendant police officers provided the Kings County District Attorney's Office with the false, misleading and/or incomplete information that Plaintiff committed crimes.

36. Specifically, the defendant police officers falsely stated to the Kings County District Attorney's Office that Plaintiff was engaged in Obstructing Governmental Administration, Resisting Arrest, and Consumption of Alcohol on the Street.

37. On or about April 26, 2023, Plaintiff was arraigned in criminal court and charged with crimes he did not commit.

38. Despite the defendant officers' false representations, Plaintiff was released on his own recognizance.

39. Plaintiff immediately sought emergency medical care at Brookdale Hospital, where x-rays revealed the right thumb fracture.

40. Plaintiff was provided a splint which he would wear for approximately six (6) weeks.

41. On or about July 31, 2023, all charges against Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed in their entirety.

42. Plaintiff received physical therapy for his thumb for approximately two (2) months following the removal of the splint.

43. Plaintiff still suffers limited mobility in his right hand, has permanent keloid scarring on his face as a result of the injuries inflicted upon him by the defendant officers, as well as mental and emotional injuries.

44. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably arresting, confining, and using excessive force against Plaintiff.

45. The unlawful arrest, confinement, and use of excessive force by the individually named defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological, and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligence

46. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

47. Defendants owed a duty of care to Plaintiff.

48. To the extent defendants claim that the injuries to Plaintiff by the defendant police officers were unintentionally caused and that the force used by the defendants against him was unintentional, then the defendants breached that duty of care by, among other things, slamming him to the ground and tightly handcuffing him.

49. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

50. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault or provocation by Plaintiff.

51. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

52. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

53. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION
Unlawful Stop, Question, and Search

54. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

55. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and grab employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

56. The conduct of defendants in approaching, stopping, and grabbing Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

57. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

58. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

59. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION
Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Unlawful Seizure and Deprivation of Liberty

60. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

61. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

62. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION
False Arrest/Imprisonment

63. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

64. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

65. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

66. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

67. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

68. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights: Excessive Force

69. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

70. The use of excessive force by defendants by, amongst other things, slamming him to the ground, smashing his face into the concrete, and tightly handcuffing him, constituted objectively unreasonable physical seizures of Plaintiff in violation of his rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

71. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

72. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

73. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff.

74. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

75. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

76. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

77. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

78. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

79. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

80. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

81. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

82. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

83. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

84. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

85. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered serious, debilitating and permanent injury, his liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear for his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

86. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

87. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

88. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

89. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights: Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

90. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

91. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

92. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

93. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

94. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, Defendants violated Plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under

the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

95. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

96. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

97. The City, as the employer of the officer Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

98. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of Defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries including, but not limited to: economic, emotional, and psychological injuries.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
42 U.S.C. § 1983 and New York State Law
Malicious Prosecution

99. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

100. The acts and conduct of the Defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the United States Constitution and the State of New York.

101. Defendants commenced and continued criminal proceedings against Plaintiff.

102. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiff and for each of the charges for which he was prosecuted.

103. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Assault

104. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

105. Defendants, their agents, servants, and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully, and maliciously assaulted Plaintiff in that they had the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and

intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff, that such acts caused apprehension of such contact in the Plaintiff.

106. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

107. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

108. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

109. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Battery

110. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

111. Defendants, their agents, servants, and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully, and maliciously battered Plaintiff when they, in a hostile and/or offensive manner, slammed him to the concrete and wrenched his thumb backward, causing severe physical injuries and brutally effecting an arrest of Plaintiff without his consent and with the intention of causing harmful and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff and caused such battery.

112. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

113. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

114. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

115. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deliberate Indifference to Medical Needs

116. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

117. Defendant officers, despite being aware that Plaintiff was suffering bodily injury from their conduct in arresting him, thereby requiring treatment from medical professionals, delayed and denied Plaintiff medical treatment and refused to administer and properly procure immediate and adequate medical attention.

118. The delay and denial of medical treatment to Plaintiff's injuries resulted in increased severity in Plaintiff's injuries that would have been prevented had Plaintiff received treatment in a timely manner.

119. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the United States Constitution.

FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Individual Defendant Officer's Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

120. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

121. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom, or usage.

122. The acts of Defendant Officers caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

123. The Defendant Officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized, frisked, and searched the Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing his detention for approximately twenty-four (24) hours in total.

124. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

FIFTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Individual Defendant Officer's Failure to Intervene in Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

125. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

126. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.

127. Defendant Officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

128. The Defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's AC 8-802 right against unreasonable search and seizure and excessive force had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

129. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failed in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of his rights.

130. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

SIXTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

City-Employer's Liability for Defendant Officer's Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

126. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

127. Defendant Officers are "covered individuals," as defined in 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 - 801 in that they are employees of the Police Department or persons appointed by the Police Commissioner as a Special Patrolman.

128. The City of New York, as the employer of the covered individual Defendant Officers, is liable to the Plaintiff for the wrongdoing of the covered individual Defendant Officers.

129. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.

130. The acts of Defendant Officers caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

131. The Defendant Officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized, frisked, and searched the Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing his detention for approximately twenty-four (24) hours in total.

132. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

SEVENTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

City-Employer's Liability for Defendant Officer's Failure to Intervene in Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

133. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

134. Defendant Officers are "covered individuals," as defined in 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 - 801 in that they are employees of the Police Department or persons appointed by the Police Commissioner as a Special Patrolman.

135. The City of New York, as the employer of the covered individual Defendant Officers, is liable to the Plaintiff for the wrongdoing of the covered individual Defendant Officers.

136. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.

137. Defendant Officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

138. The Defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's AC 8 – 802 rights against unreasonable search and seizure and excessive force had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

139. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failed in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of his rights.

140. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

EIGHTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Article I, § 12 of the New York State Constitution

131. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the above paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.

132. Such conduct breached the protections guaranteed to plaintiff by the New York State Constitution, including but not limited to, Article 1, §§ 1, 6, 8, 9, 11, and 12, and including the following rights:

- i. freedom from unreasonable search and seizure of his person and property;
- ii. freedom from arrest without probable cause;
- iii. freedom from false imprisonment, that being wrongfully detained without good faith, reasonable suspicion, or legal justification, and of which wrongful detention plaintiff was aware and did not consent;
- iv. freedom from the lodging of false charges against him by police officers and prosecutors, including on information and belief, by some or all of the individual defendants; and
- v. freedom from deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

133. As a direct and proximate result of defendants' deprivations of Plaintiff's rights, privileges, and immunities guaranteed by the New York State Constitution, Plaintiff suffered physical, economic and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

134. As a result of the above tortious conduct, Plaintiff was caused to suffer physical, economic, and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

135. As a result of the above unconstitutional conduct, the City of New York is liable for the conduct of the Individual Defendants and any damages they caused under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

JURY DEMAND

141. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

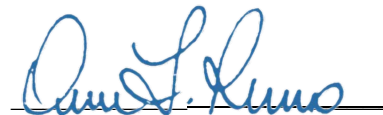
PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff, GEORGE JOHNSON, JR., demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law, and that the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988 and 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 801 *et seq.*

DATED: New York, New York
April 3, 2024

Yours, etc.

SHULMAN & HILL, PLLC



Omar T. Russo, Esq.

Attorneys for Plaintiff

1 State Street Plaza, 15th Floor
New York, New York 10004

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, New York, New York 10007

NYPD POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER MEYER, Shield No. 18501, NYPD 75th Precinct; 1000 Sutter Avenue, Brooklyn, New York 11208

NYPD POLICE OFFICER BRANDON R. GENTZ, Shield No. 9505, NYPD 75th Precinct; 1000 Sutter Avenue, Brooklyn, New York 11208

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

OMAR T. RUSSO, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the

State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **SHULMAN-HILL PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
April 3, 2024



OMAR T. RUSSO